

Overview

- Diffie-Hellman key agreement (also called exponential key exchange or Diffie-Hellman key exchange) provided the first practical solution to the secret key distribution problem.
- It is based on public-key cryptography.
- This protocol enables two parties, say A and B , which have never communicated before, to establish a mutual secret key by exchanging messages over a public channel.



Figure: Prof. Whitfield Diffie

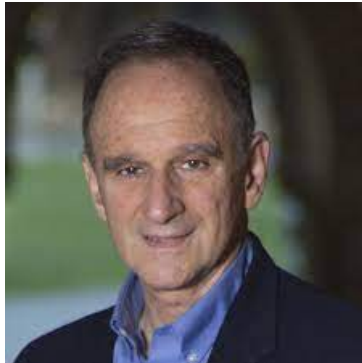


Figure: Prof. Martin Hellman

Me with Prof. Martin Hellman (15 February 2018 at IIIT Hyderabad)



Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange Protocol (continued)

Global Public Elements

- q : a sufficiently large prime, such that it is intractable to compute the discrete logarithms in $Z_q^* = \{1, 2, \dots, q-1\}$
(Given α , q and $y = \alpha^x \pmod{q}$, to find discrete logarithm $x \in Z_q^*$).
- α : $\alpha < q$ and α a primitive root of q .
(Compute $\alpha^1 \pmod{q}$, $\alpha^2 \pmod{q}$, $\dots$, $\alpha^{q-1} \pmod{q}$.
If all are distinct and $\alpha^{q-1} \pmod{q} = 1$, α is primitive root of q)

User A Key Generation

- Select private X_A such that $X_A < q$
- Calculate public Y_A such that $Y_A = \alpha^{X_A} \pmod{q}$

$A \rightarrow B : \{Y_A, q, \alpha\}$

Here $A \rightarrow B : M$ denotes party A sends a message M to party B .

Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange Protocol (continued)

User B Key Generation

- Select private X_B such that $X_B < q$
- Calculate public Y_B such that $Y_B = \alpha^{X_B} \bmod q$

$B \rightarrow A : \{Y_B\}$

Generation of secret key by User A

$$\bullet K_{A,B} = (Y_B)^{X_A} \bmod q$$

Generation of secret key by User B

$$\bullet K_{B,A} = (Y_A)^{X_B} \bmod q$$

Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange Protocol (continued)

Summary

User A	User B
1. Select private X_A 2. Calculate public Y_A 3. $\underline{Y_A = \alpha^{X_A} \bmod q}$	1. Select private X_B 2. Calculate public Y_B 3. $\underline{Y_B = \alpha^{X_B} \bmod q}$
4. $K_{A,B} = (Y_B)^{X_A} \bmod q$	4. $K_{B,A} = (Y_A)^{X_B} \bmod q$

Correctness Proof

$$\begin{aligned}K_{A,B} &= (Y_B)^{X_A} \bmod q \text{ [User A]} \\&= (\alpha^{X_B} \bmod q)^{X_A} \bmod q \\&= (\alpha)^{X_B \cdot X_A} \bmod q \\&= (\alpha^{X_A})^{X_B} \bmod q \\&= (\alpha^{X_A} \bmod q)^{X_B} \bmod q \\&= (Y_A)^{X_B} \bmod q \\&= K_{B,A} \text{ [User B]}\end{aligned}$$

Problem [Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange]

Users A and B use the Diffie-Hellman key exchange technique with a common prime $q = 71$ and a primitive root $\alpha = 7$.

- (a) If user A has private key $X_A = 5$, what is the A 's public key Y_A ?
- (b) If user B has private key $X_B = 12$, what is the B 's public key Y_B ?
- (c) What is the secret shared key?

Solution: Here $q = 71$ and $\alpha = 7$.

(a) A 's public key Y_A is given by

$$\begin{aligned} Y_A &= \alpha^{X_A} \bmod q \\ &= 7^5 \bmod 71 \\ &= (7^1 \bmod 71) \times (7^4 \bmod 71) \bmod 71 \\ &= 51 \end{aligned}$$

Problem [Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange] (Continued...)

(b) B 's public key Y_B is given by

$$\begin{aligned} Y_B &= \alpha^{X_B} \bmod q \\ &= 7^{12} \bmod 71 \\ &= (7^4 \bmod 71) \times (7^8 \bmod 71) \bmod 71 \\ &= 4 \end{aligned}$$

(c) The secret shared key K is given by

$$\begin{aligned} K_{A,B} &= (Y_B)^{X_A} \bmod q \text{ [User A]} \\ &= 4^5 \bmod 71 \\ &= 30 \end{aligned}$$

Problem [Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange] (Continued...)

$$\begin{aligned}K_{B,A} &= (Y_A)^{X_B} \bmod q \text{ [User B]} \\&= 51^{12} \bmod 71 \\&= 30\end{aligned}$$

$K = K_{A,B} = K_{B,A} = 30$ is the required secret shared key between A and B .



Online Demo on Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange Protocol

- Generating primitive root of prime
- Computing the shared session key between two parties

<http://www.irongeek.com/diffie-hellman.php?>

Further Readings (Cryptography and Network Security)

- William Stallings, “Cryptography and Network Security: Principles and Practices”, Pearson Education, 2010.
- Behrouz A. Forouzan, “Cryptography and Network Security”, Special Indian Edition.
- Bernard Menezes, “Network Security and Cryptography”, Cengage Learning, 2010.
- A. Menezes, P. Oorschot and S. Vanstone, “Handbook of Applied Cryptography”, CRC Press.
- B. Schneier, “Applied Cryptography”, Reading, MA: Addison-Wesley, 2006.
- D. Stinson, “Cryptography: Theory and Practice”, Chapman & Hall/CRC, 2006.
- Neal Koblitz, “A course in number theory and cryptography”, Springer.

Thank you